

cover story NUCLEAR DEAL

■ By Prabhu Chawla

Nuclear science may be not for your average journalist, but now nuclear politics is turning out to be a treacherous beat. Ideological fission and opportunistic chain reaction can blow you off-course. As the intimations of a nuclear winter chills South Block, the political class has taken refuge in lofty catch phrases like national interest, compromised sovereignty and international responsibility. It is as if everyone, including the communists, loves this country so much and the measure of your national allegiance is either your support or opposition to the UPA Government's nuclear deal with America—a deal whose nuances are unlikely to be a mobilising slogan in the eventuality of an election. It is a scenario in which none of the main players—the communist, the nationalist or the newly nuclear secularist—is a winner. This monsoon is turning out to be a season of national let-downs, with all the political protagonists indulging in the worst kind of ideological adventurism.

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